

Freelancer Client Onboarding Kit: 6 Done-for-You Templates

RenWork Digital Products

Template 1: The "Project Confirmed" Welcome Email

****Subject:**** Welcome Aboard, [Client Name]! ? Let's Build Something Great

Hi [Client Name],

First and foremost, thank you for trusting me with this project. I am genuinely excited to collaborate with you and help [Company Name] achieve [specific goal mentioned in inquiry, e.g., a stronger brand presence/increased leads].

Now that we've officially signed the contract, here is exactly what happens next so you know what to expect:

1. ****Questionnaire:**** I've just sent you a link to my Project Kickoff Questionnaire. Please complete this within the next 3 days. This helps me understand your vision deeply before we schedule our call.
2. ****Kickoff Call:**** Once I receive your answers, I will send you a calendar link to book our 45-minute strategy session. We will review your goals and finalize the creative direction.
3. ****Timeline & Milestones:**** Within 48 hours of our call, you will receive the detailed project roadmap, including all deadlines and review windows.
4. ****First Deliverable:**** As per our agreement, the first draft of [Deliverable Name] will be ready for your review by [Date].

During this phase, my focus is on minimizing back-and-forth emails. I will handle the heavy lifting on the strategy and execution, while you focus on providing timely feedback on the critical milestones.

If you have any immediate questions before the questionnaire, feel free to reply to this email.

Otherwise, I'll see you at the kickoff call!

Best,

[Your Name]

[Your Title/Studio]

[Link to Your Portfolio/Website]

Template 2: Project Kickoff Questionnaire (20 Questions)

Note to Freelancer: Send this via Typeform, Google Forms, or a simple PDF. Encourage clients to answer in their own words, not just keywords.

Section 1: Goals & Strategy

1. What is the single most important business objective this project must achieve? (e.g., increase sales by 10%, launch a new product, rebrand)
2. How will you measure the success of this project? Please provide specific KPIs or metrics.
3. Who are your top 3 competitors? What do you admire about their approach, and what do you dislike?
4. What has been your biggest challenge in achieving this goal in the past?

Section 2: Audience & User

5. Describe your ideal customer in detail. Who are they? (Age, location, profession, pain points)
6. What is the primary emotion you want your audience to feel when interacting with this deliverable?
7. Where does your audience spend the most time online? (Specific platforms or websites)
8. Are there any specific demographics you are **not** trying to target?

Section 3: Brand Voice & Identity

9. If your brand were a person, how would you describe their personality in three words? (e.g., Bold, Playful, Professional)
10. What is the tone of voice you prefer? (e.g., Conversational, Authoritative, Witty, Empathetic)
11. Are there any words, phrases, or slang you absolutely never want to see?
12. Do you have existing brand guidelines? If yes, please attach them. If no, please share 3 examples of brands you admire and explain why.
13. What visual style do you avoid? (e.g., overly minimalist, cluttered, corporate, dark mode)

****Section 4: Deliverables & Logistics****

14. What are the specific technical requirements for the final files? (e.g., file formats, dimensions, resolution)
15. Who will be the primary point of contact for feedback on my end?
16. Who else needs to approve the final deliverables? Please list them by name and role.
17. Are there any specific dates or events that this work must be live before? (Hard deadlines)
18. What is the best time of day/week for you to provide detailed feedback?
19. Do you have any existing assets (logos, photos, copy) I should use? Please provide a list of links or files.
20. Is there anything else you think I should know that we haven't covered?

Template 3: Onboarding Checklist

Send this as a standalone document or a shared Trello/Asana board. It ensures accountability on both sides.

****Part A: Client Actions (Your Side)****

- * ☐ ****Access & Credentials:**** Provide login credentials for all necessary platforms (CMS, Social Media, Analytics) or grant guest access.
- * ☐ ****Brand Assets:**** Send all high-resolution logos (vector preferred), brand fonts, and color palettes.
- * ☐ ****Content Review:**** Review the initial brief and confirm the target audience definition.
- * ☐ ****Feedback Schedule:**** Confirm availability for the initial review window (e.g., "I will have 2 hours on Thursday afternoon for feedback").
- * ☐ ****Asset Approval:**** Review and approve any stock imagery or third-party assets suggested in the first draft.

****Part B: Freelancer Setup (My Side)****

- * ☐ ****Project Folder Creation:**** Set up a centralized drive with subfolders for Raw Files, Work in Progress, Final Exports, and Contracts.
- * ☐ ****Timeline Integration:**** Add all milestones to the master calendar and share the link with the client.
- * ☐ ****Tool Configuration:**** Set up communication channels (Slack/Email) and project management tools with the client.

* [] ****Scope Definition:**** Explicitly list out-of-scope items in the project brief to prevent confusion later.

* [] ****Initial Research:**** Conduct competitor analysis and market research to inform the creative strategy.

Template 4: Communication Expectations One-Pager

****1. Response Times****

* ****Business Hours:**** I am available Monday-Friday, 9 AM - 5 PM [Time Zone].

* ****Standard Response:**** I aim to respond to all emails and messages within 4 business hours.

* ****Urgent Matters:**** If something is truly urgent, please mark the subject line ****[URGENT]**** or call the number on your contract. Urgent requests may incur an additional fee if they fall outside standard working hours.

****2. The Feedback Loop****

* ****Consolidated Feedback:**** To keep the project moving efficiently, please consolidate your feedback into a single document or email per review phase. Avoid sending multiple small comments

over several days.

* ****Specificity:**** When requesting changes, please specify **what** isn't working and **why**. "I don't like it" is not actionable. "The headline feels too aggressive for our audience; can we try a softer tone?" is actionable.

****3. Revision Policy****

* ****Inclusions:**** This project includes [Number] rounds of revisions per deliverable.

* ****Definition of a Revision:**** A revision is a change to the work presented in a draft. It is not a change of direction based on new information or a complete redesign.

* ****Additional Revisions:**** If you require changes beyond the included rounds, or if the scope of the project changes, we will discuss a rate of \$[Amount]/hour or a flat fee for additional work.

****4. Meeting Etiquette****

* Please join calls 2 minutes early.

* Have your notes ready.

* If we are more than 5 minutes late, I will reschedule to respect your time.

Template 5: Project Timeline Template

Customize dates based on your project length. This template assumes a standard 4-week project.

Phase 1: Strategy & Discovery (Week 1)

- * **Day 1-2:** Kickoff Call & Questionnaire Review.
- * **Day 3-4:** Competitor Research & Mood Boarding.
- * **Day 5:** **Milestone 1:** Presentation of Creative Direction/Mood Board.
- * **Client Action:** Provide feedback on direction (24-hour turnaround recommended).

Phase 2: Drafting & Design (Week 2)

- * **Day 6-8:** First Draft Creation (Copy/Design).
- * **Day 9:** Internal Quality Assurance.
- * **Day 10:** **Milestone 2:** Delivery of First Draft.
- * **Client Action:** Review draft and provide consolidated feedback (3-day turnaround).

Phase 3: Refinement & Revisions (Week 3)

- * **Day 11-13:** Implementing Revision Round 1.
- * **Day 14:** **Milestone 3:** Delivery of Second Draft (Revised).
- * **Client Action:** Final review and approval (2-day turnaround).

Phase 4: Finalization & Handoff (Week 4)

- * **Day 15-16:** Final Polish, Export, and Asset Organization.
- * **Day 17:** **Milestone 4:** Delivery of Final Files.
- * **Day 18-19:** Handoff Meeting: Reviewing